

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Using an AED

MEDICAL / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

For an unresponsive person who is not breathing normally, call emergency services and begin CPR. Turn on the AED as soon as it arrives and follow its voice and picture prompts. Do not touch the person during rhythm analysis or a shock.

Do now.

**Turn it on**

01

Continue CPR while another helper prepares the AED if possible.

**Expose the chest**

02

Dry a wet chest and place pads according to the AED diagrams.

**Stand clear**

03

Make sure no one touches the person during analysis or shock delivery.

**Resume CPR**

04

Immediately follow the device instructions to continue compressions.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

If nobody can bring an AED, continue CPR rather than leaving the person to search alone. If another person is present, ask them to locate the nearest accessible AED while you continue compressions. Follow the device prompts when it arrives.

Watch for.

For a child or infant, use the appropriate pediatric pads or setting when available and follow the device and dispatcher instructions.

People & practical needs.

Give someone the specific task of calling or locating care while another person provides first aid. Keep the patient warm or cool as the condition requires and record what happened and when

Next decision.

Keep the AED connected until responders take over. Learn the location of nearby devices and obtain training.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Using an AED · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/aed/>